

Python

Recursion



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Agenda

- ① what is recursion?
- ② Recursion Tree
- ③ How to approach recursive solution?

Recursion

Function calling itself is called recursion.

```
def f1():
```

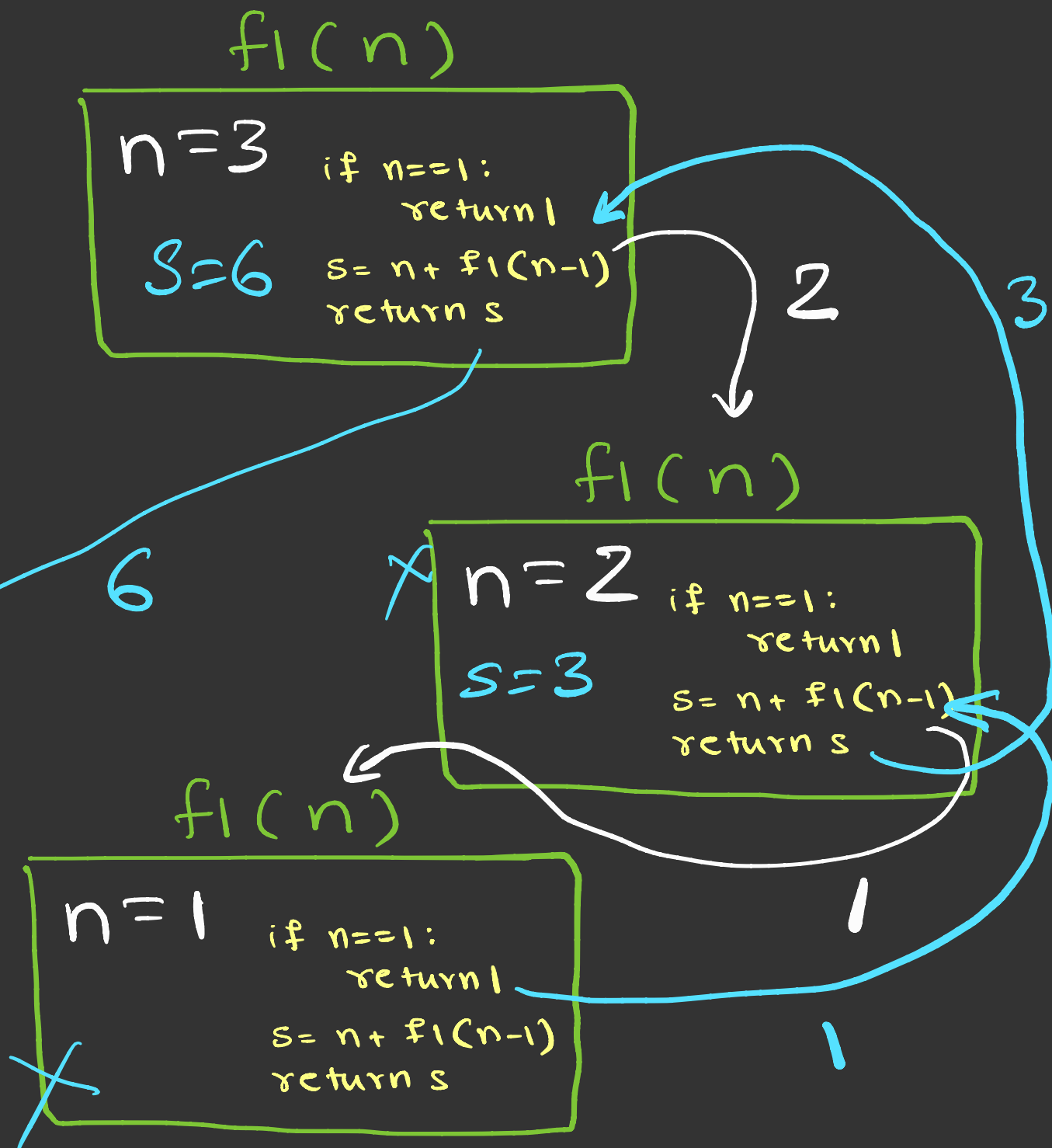
```
    =
```

```
    f1()
```

```
    =
```

```
def f1(n):  
    if n==1:  
        return 1  
    s = n + f1(n-1)  
    return s
```

```
x = f1(3)  
print(x)
```



$$f_1(3) = 6$$

$f(n)$

$$f_1(10) \rightarrow 10 + f_1(9)$$

$$\hookrightarrow 9 + f_1(8)$$

$$\hookrightarrow 8 + f_1(7)$$

$$7 + f_1(6) \swarrow$$

$$6 + f_1(5) \swarrow$$

$$5 + f_1(4) \swarrow$$

$$\hookrightarrow 4 + f_1(3)$$

$$\hookrightarrow 3 + f_1(2)$$

$$\hookrightarrow 2 + f_1(1)$$

$$10 + 9 + 8 + 7 + 6 + 5 + 4 + 3 + 2 + 1 \hookrightarrow 1$$

$$f_1(n) = \begin{cases} 1 & n = 1 \\ n + f_1(n-1) & n > 1 \end{cases}$$

- In recursion, problem is solved in terms of problem itself
- Each time recursive function call to itself for little simpler version of the original problem

$$f_1(10) = 10 + f_1(9)$$

$$f_1(n) = n + f_1(n-1)$$

How to approach recursive function?

Write a recursive function to calculate sum of first n natural numbers.

① $\text{sum}(n)$ $1+2+3+4+\dots+n$

RC ② $n + \text{sum}(n-1)$ $1+2+3+\dots+n-1$

BC ③ $n == 1$ 1

```
def sum(n):
```

```
    if  $n == 1$ :
```

```
        return 1
```

```
    return  $n + \text{sum}(n-1)$ 
```